

Product Warranty Policy

Policy ID: WAR-001 **Version:** 1.8 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2026

Owner: Product Support **Review Frequency:** Annually

1. Purpose

This policy defines how product defects and warranty claims should be evaluated and escalated.

2. Warranty Coverage

Warranty coverage depends on:

* Product category. * Purchase date. * Product model. * Applicable warranty period. * Nature of the reported problem.

The existence of a product problem does not automatically establish warranty eligibility.

3. Reporting a Defect

When a customer reports a defective product, support should collect:

* Order ID. * Product ID. * Description of the problem. * Date the problem was discovered. * Relevant photographs or documentation when required. * Troubleshooting information where applicable.

4. Warranty Investigation

The investigation should determine:

1. Whether the product can be identified. 2. Whether the purchase can be verified. 3. Whether the product is within the warranty period. 4. Whether the reported problem appears consistent with warranty coverage. 5. Whether additional evidence is required.

5. Manufacturing Defects

A suspected manufacturing defect should be escalated when the issue cannot be resolved through standard troubleshooting.

Possible resolutions include:

* Replacement. * Repair. * Refund where authorized. * Other approved remedy.

The automated agent should recommend the appropriate workflow but should not independently approve a remedy.

6. Accidental Damage

Damage caused by accidents, misuse, unauthorized modifications, or improper handling may not qualify for standard warranty coverage.

The automated agent should not make a definitive determination when the cause of damage is unclear.

Such cases should be escalated.

7. Warranty Expiration

If the purchase date indicates that the applicable warranty period has expired:

* Inform the customer that the warranty may no longer apply. * Do not guarantee that the claim will be rejected. * Escalate when an exception may apply.

8. Repeated Failures

Repeated failures of the same product may require elevated review.

If a product has undergone multiple repairs or replacements for the same issue, support should escalate the case to a specialist.

9. Missing Purchase Information

If the customer cannot provide sufficient information to verify the purchase:

* Search available internal records. * Do not invent purchase information. * Request additional information when appropriate. * Escalate if eligibility cannot be established.

10. Automated Agent Restrictions

The agent may:

* Gather information. * Explain warranty requirements. * Search warranty policies. * Recommend troubleshooting. * Recommend escalation. * Draft customer communications.

The agent may not:

* Declare a product defective with certainty. * Approve a warranty claim. * Promise a replacement. * Promise a refund. * Override warranty restrictions.

11. Escalation Rules

Escalate when:

* Warranty eligibility is unclear. * Product damage has an uncertain cause. * The customer disputes a warranty determination. * There are repeated product failures. * Purchase information conflicts. * The requested remedy requires authorization.

12. Decision Principle

Warranty decisions must be based on verified purchase information and applicable product rules.

When evidence is insufficient, human review is preferred over unsupported assumptions.